

Project updates

Project

- Students work individually or in pairs on a topic of choice
- The starting point is a relevant research paper from outside the course reading list: **you select it**, situate it, and propose a study
 - This choice is important to discuss if needed and plan ahead

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- The starting point is a relevant research paper from outside the course reading list: **you select it**, situate it, and propose a study
 - This choice is important to discuss if needed and plan ahead
- Notice that the project is just **a conceptual proposal (no data analysis, data collection, experiments, etc.)**
- **No double-dipping**
 - The problem might naturally be something you're interested in and are already working on (in your research, for another class project)
 - This is fine--but the 2-page proposal should be substantially different and original. If unsure, discuss!

Project

- The proposed project might be about applying, validating, or critically evaluating AI methods for social science research
- A starting point can be an open problem or an existing application
- The extension needs **a thesis statement** (you will be asked in the submission form)
- The project runs in stages:
 - a written proposal including a literature review + with an in-class proposal presentation **(2 page, template shared)**
 - a final presentation with a conference-style report of 4 pages **(ACL 2 column format)**
 - with potential for publication*

Hypothetical examples

Topic: AI hypothesis generation methods

First 2 pages: A detailed description of one selected paper (outside of the class reading list)
+ a literature review of the topic

Last 2 pages: A creative extension

- Kavya: *“it would be interesting and important if we actually went ahead and ran an experiment to test these hypotheses”*
- The extension argument becomes: Evaluating AI-generated hypotheses requires in vivo conduction of experiment
- The concrete proposed study is a fully outlined example A/B test with real users (study design, hypotheses, what kinds of results would let us conclude what)

Hypothetical examples

Topic: AI hypothesis generation methods

First 2 pages: A detailed description of one selected paper (outside of the class reading list) + a literature review of the topic

Last 2 pages: A creative extension

- Zini: “*What does it even mean to be unknown..?*”
- The extension argument becomes: Evaluating AI-generated hypotheses requires engaging with theoretical constructs of novelty and developing new taxonomies of novelty
- The concrete proposed study is a fully outlined taxonomy and evaluation protocol

Hypothetical examples

Topic: AI simulations in truly unknown scenarios

First 2 pages: A detailed description of one selected paper (outside of the class reading list) + a literature review of the topic

Last 2 pages: A creative extension

- Shao: *“we could take stories from books that were just published and see if AI agents could reproduce these unseen behaviors or narrative structures”*
- The extension argument becomes: Evaluating simulations requires truly unknown settings and newly published books provide one opportunity for such testing
- The concrete proposed study is a fully outlined example study and a fleshed out evaluation protocol

Hypothetical examples

Timeline

Fri, Oct 9: Project literature review and proposal due (2 pages)

Template: [Overleaf](#)

Mon, Oct 12: Project Proposal Presentations

Questions?